

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Stem Cell Transplantation (Formerly 110.8.1)

110.23

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

110.23

Manual Section Title

Stem Cell Transplantation (Formerly 110.8.1)

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

03/06/2024

Implementation Date

10/07/2024

Description Information

Benefit Category

Inpatient Hospital Services

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Stem cell transplantation is a process in which stem cells are harvested from either a patient's (autologous) or donor's (allogeneic) bone marrow or peripheral blood for intravenous infusion. Autologous stem cell transplantation (AuSCT) is a technique for restoring stem cells using the patient's own previously stored cells. AuSCT must be used to effect hematopoietic reconstitution following severely myelotoxic doses of chemotherapy (HDCT) and/or radiotherapy used to treat various malignancies. Allogeneic hematopoietic stem cell transplantation (HSCT) is a procedure in which a portion of a healthy donor's stem cell or bone marrow is obtained and prepared for intravenous infusion. Allogeneic HSCT may be used to restore function in recipients having an inherited or acquired deficiency or defect. Hematopoietic stem cells are multi-potent stem cells that give rise to all the blood cell types; these stem cells form blood and immune cells. A hematopoietic stem cell is a cell isolated from blood or bone marrow that can renew itself, differentiate to a variety of specialized cells, can mobilize out of the bone marrow into circulating blood, and can undergo programmed cell death, called apoptosis - a process by which cells that are unneeded or detrimental will self-destruct.

The Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) is clarifying that bone marrow and peripheral blood stem cell transplantation is a process which includes mobilization, harvesting, and transplant of bone marrow or peripheral blood stem cells and the administration of high dose chemotherapy or radiotherapy prior to the actual transplant. When bone marrow or peripheral blood stem cell transplantation is covered, all necessary steps are included in coverage. When bone marrow or peripheral blood stem cell transplantation is non-covered, none of the steps are covered.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

I. Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation (HSCT)

- a. Effective for services performed on or after August 1, 1978, for the treatment of leukemia, leukemia in remission, or aplastic anemia when it is reasonable and necessary,
- b. Effective for services performed on or after June 3, 1985, for the treatment of severe combined immunodeficiency disease (SCID) and for the treatment of Wiskott-Aldrich syndrome.
- c. Effective for services performed on or after March 6, 2024, allogeneic hematopoietic stem cell transplant using bone marrow, peripheral blood or umbilical cord blood stem cell products for Medicare patients with myelodysplastic syndromes who have prognostic risk scores of:

- ≥ 1.5 (Intermediate-2 or high) using the International Prognostic Scoring System (IPSS), or
- ≥ 4.5 (high or very high) using the International Prognostic Scoring System - Revised (IPSS-R), or
- ≥ 0.5 (high or very high) using the Molecular International Prognostic Scoring System (IPSS-M).

MDS refers to a group of diverse blood disorders in which the bone marrow does not produce enough healthy, functioning blood cells. These disorders are varied with regard to clinical characteristics, cytologic and pathologic features, and cytogenetics. The abnormal production of blood cells in the bone marrow leads to low blood cell counts, referred to as cytopenias, which are a hallmark feature of MDS along with a dysplastic and hypercellular-appearing bone marrow.

- d. Effective for claims with dates of service on or after January 27, 2016, allogeneic HSCT for multiple myeloma is covered by Medicare only for beneficiaries with Durie-Salmon Stage II or III multiple myeloma, or International Staging System (ISS) Stage II or Stage III multiple myeloma, and participating in an approved prospective clinical study that meets the criteria below. There must be appropriate statistical techniques to control for selection bias and confounding by age, duration of diagnosis, disease classification, International Myeloma Working Group (IMWG) classification, ISS stage, comorbid conditions, type of preparative/conditioning regimen, graft vs. host disease (GVHD) prophylaxis, donor type and cell source.

A prospective clinical study seeking Medicare coverage for allogeneic HSCT for multiple myeloma pursuant to CED must address the following question:

Compared to patients who do not receive allogeneic HSCT, do Medicare beneficiaries with multiple myeloma who receive allogeneic HSCT have improved outcomes as indicated by:

- Graft vs. host disease (acute and chronic);
- Other transplant-related adverse events;
- Overall survival; and
- (optional) Quality of life?

All CMS-approved clinical studies and registries must adhere to the below listed standards of scientific integrity and relevance to the Medicare population as listed in section g.

- e. Effective for claims with dates of service on or after January 27, 2016, allogeneic HSCT for myelofibrosis (MF) is covered by Medicare only for beneficiaries with Dynamic International Prognostic Scoring System (DIPSSplus) Intermediate-2 or High primary or secondary MF and participating in an approved prospective clinical study. All Medicare

approved studies must use appropriate statistical techniques in the analysis to control for selection bias and potential confounding by age, duration of diagnosis, disease classification, DIPSSplus score, comorbid conditions, type of preparative/conditioning regimen, graft vs. host disease (GVHD) prophylaxis, donor type and cell source.

A prospective clinical study seeking Medicare coverage for allogeneic HSCT for myelofibrosis pursuant to Coverage with Evidence Development (CED) must address the following question:

Compared to patients who do not receive allogeneic HSCT, do Medicare beneficiaries with MF who receive allogeneic HSCT transplantation have improved outcomes as indicated by:

- Graft vs. host disease (acute and chronic);
- Other transplant-related adverse events;
- Overall survival; and
- (optional) Quality of life?

All CMS-approved clinical studies and registries must adhere to the below listed standards of scientific integrity and relevance to the Medicare population as listed in section g.

- f. Effective for claims with dates of service on or after January 27, 2016, allogeneic HSCT for sickle cell disease (SCD) is covered by Medicare only for beneficiaries with severe, symptomatic SCD who participate in an approved prospective clinical study.

A prospective clinical study seeking Medicare coverage for allogeneic HSCT for sickle cell disease pursuant to Coverage with Evidence Development (CED) must address the following question:

Compared to patients who do not receive allogeneic HSCT, do Medicare beneficiaries with SCD who receive allogeneic HSCT have improved outcomes as indicated by:

- Graft vs. host disease (acute and chronic),
- Other transplant-related adverse events;
- Overall survival; and
- (optional) Quality of life?

All CMS-approved clinical studies and registries must adhere to the below listed standards of scientific integrity and relevance to the Medicare population listed in section g.

- g. All CMS-approved clinical studies and registries in sections d, e and f must adhere to the below listed standards of scientific integrity and relevance to the Medicare population:

- a. The principal purpose of the study is to test whether the item or service meaningfully improves health outcomes of affected beneficiaries who are

- represented by the enrolled subjects.
- b. The rationale for the study is well supported by available scientific and medical evidence.
 - c. The study results are not anticipated to unjustifiably duplicate existing knowledge.
 - d. The study design is methodologically appropriate and the anticipated number of enrolled subjects is sufficient to answer the research question(s) being asked in the National Coverage Determination.
 - e. The study is sponsored by an organization or individual capable of completing it successfully.
 - f. The research study is in compliance with all applicable Federal regulations concerning the protection of human subjects found in the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) at 45 CFR Part 46. If a study is regulated by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA), it is also in compliance with 21 CFR Parts 50 and 56. In addition, to further enhance the protection of human subjects in studies conducted under CED, the study must provide and obtain meaningful informed consent from patients regarding the risks associated with the study items and/or services, and the use and eventual disposition of the collected data.
 - g. All aspects of the study are conducted according to appropriate standards of scientific integrity.
 - h. The study has a written protocol that clearly demonstrates adherence to the standards listed here as Medicare requirements.
 - i. The study is not designed to exclusively test toxicity or disease pathophysiology in healthy individuals. Such studies may meet this requirement only if the disease or condition being studied is life threatening as defined in 21 CFR §312.81(a) and the patient has no other viable treatment options.
 - j. The clinical research studies and registries are registered on the www.ClinicalTrials.gov website by the principal sponsor/investigator prior to the enrollment of the first study subject. Registries are also registered in the Agency for Healthcare Quality (AHRQ) Registry of Patient Registries (RoPR).
 - k. The research study protocol specifies the method and timing of public release of all prespecified outcomes to be measured including release of outcomes if outcomes are negative or study is terminated early. The results must be made public within 12 months of the study's primary completion date, which is the date the final subject had final data collection for the primary endpoint, even if the trial does not achieve its primary aim. The results must include number started/completed, summary results for primary and secondary outcome measures, statistical analyses, and adverse events. Final results must be reported in a publicly accessible manner; either in a peer-reviewed scientific journal (in print or on-line), in an on-line publicly accessible registry dedicated to the dissemination of clinical trial information such as ClinicalTrials.gov, or in journals willing to publish in abbreviated format (e.g., for studies with negative or incomplete results).

- l. The study protocol must explicitly discuss beneficiary subpopulations affected by the item or service under investigation, particularly traditionally underrepresented groups in clinical studies, how the inclusion and exclusion criteria effect enrollment of these populations, and a plan for the retention and reporting of said populations in the trial. If the inclusion and exclusion criteria are expected to have a negative effect on the recruitment or retention of underrepresented populations, the protocol must discuss why these criteria are necessary.
- m. The study protocol explicitly discusses how the results are or are not expected to be generalizable to affected beneficiary subpopulations. Separate discussions in the protocol may be necessary for populations eligible for Medicare due to age, disability or Medicaid eligibility.

Consistent with section 1142 of the Act, the Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality (AHRQ) supports clinical research studies that CMS determines meet the above-listed standards and address the above-listed research questions.

II. Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation (AuSCT)

- a. Effective for services performed on or after April 28, 1989, AuSCT is considered reasonable and necessary under §1862(a)(1)(A) of the Act for the following conditions and is covered under Medicare for patients with:
 - 1. Acute leukemia in remission who have a high probability of relapse and who have no human leucocyte antigens (HLA)-matched;
 - 2. Resistant non-Hodgkin's lymphomas or those presenting with poor prognostic features following an initial response;
 - 3. Recurrent or refractory neuroblastoma; or,
 - 4. Advanced Hodgkin's disease who have failed conventional therapy and have no HLA-matched donor.
- b. Effective October 1, 2000, single AuSCT is only covered for Durie-Salmon Stage II or III patients that fit the following requirements:
 - Newly diagnosed or responsive multiple myeloma. This includes those patients with previously untreated disease, those with at least a partial response to prior chemotherapy (defined as a 50% decrease either in measurable paraprotein [serum and/or urine] or in bone marrow infiltration, sustained for at least 1 month), and those in responsive relapse; and
 - Adequate cardiac, renal, pulmonary, and hepatic function.
- c. Effective for services performed on or after March 15, 2005, when recognized clinical risk factors are employed to select patients for transplantation, high dose melphalan (HDM) together with AuSCT is reasonable and necessary for Medicare beneficiaries of

any age group with primary amyloid light chain (AL) amyloidosis who meet the following criteria:

- Amyloid deposition in 2 or fewer organs; and,
- Cardiac left ventricular ejection fraction (EF) greater than 45%.

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

I. Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation (HSCT)

Effective for claims with dates of service on or after May 24, 1996, through January 26, 2016, allogeneic HSCT is not covered as treatment for multiple myeloma.

II. Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation (AuSCT)

Insufficient data exist to establish definite conclusions regarding the efficacy of AuSCT for the following conditions:

- a. Acute leukemia not in remission;
- b. Chronic granulocytic leukemia;
- c. Solid tumors (other than neuroblastoma);
- d. Up to October 1, 2000, multiple myeloma;
- e. Tandem transplantation (multiple rounds of AuSCT) for patients with multiple myeloma;
- f. Effective October 1, 2000, non-primary AL amyloidosis; and,
- g. Effective October 1, 2000, through March 14, 2005, primary AL amyloidosis for Medicare beneficiaries age 64 or older.

In these cases, AuSCT is not considered reasonable and necessary within the meaning of §1862(a)(1)(A) of the Act and is not covered under Medicare.

D. Other

Coverage of all other indications for stem cell transplantation not otherwise specified above as covered or non-covered will be made by local Medicare Administrative Contractors under section 1862(a)(1)(A).

(This NCD last reviewed **March 2024**.)

Cross Reference

[CED page - Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplant for MDS](#) 

[CED page - Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplant for Multiple Myeloma](#) 

[CED page - Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplant for Myelofibrosis](#) 

[CED page - Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplant for Sickle Cell Disease](#) 

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 12627 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

[TN 12868 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

12813

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/regulations-and-guidance/guidance/transmittals/2024-transmittals/r12813ncd> 

Revision History

03/2025 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a quarterly maintenance update of ICD-10 coding conversions and other coding updates specific to National Coverage Determinations (NCDs). No policy is being changed as a result of these updates. ([TN 13097](#) ) (CR13939)

11/2024 - Transmittal 12868 issued October 07, 2024, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 12948, dated November 6, 2024, to revise BR 04.4.2 and messaging and add new BR 04.4.2.1 and to update the ICD-10 spreadsheet and IOM for publication 100-04. All other information remains the same. ([TN 12948](#) ) (CR13604)

10/2024 - The purpose of the Change Request (CR) is to provide a quarterly maintenance update of ICD-10 coding conversions and other coding updates specific to National Coverage Determinations (NCDs). No policy is being changed as a result of these updates. ([TN 12903](#) ) (CR13818)

10/2024 - Transmittal 12813 issued August 28, 2024, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 12868, dated October 7, 2024, to revise line 8 of the attached spreadsheet to align with billing guidance in Claims Processing Manual (CPM), and revise Pub 100-04 BR

04.3.3 and CPM to add Group Code PR to messaging. This correction does not make any revisions to Pub. 100-03. All other information remains the same. ([TN 12868](#)) (CR13604)

08/2024 - Transmittal 12781 issued August 21, 2024, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 12813, dated August 28, 2024, to replace the Pub.100-03 NCD Manual with the correct document that includes sections d-g for Section 1. Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell. All other information remains the same.

05/2024 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to inform contractors that CMS is expanding Medicare coverage for allogeneic hematopoietic stem cell transplant using bone marrow, peripheral blood or umbilical cord blood stem cell products for Medicare patients with MDS who meet specific criteria. ([TN 12627](#)) (CR13604)

02/2024 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. ([TN 12493](#)) (CR13507)

Revision History of 110.8.1 (see NCD110.23, [CR9620](#), effective 1/27/16)

10/2022 - Transmittal 11546, dated August 4, 2022, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11636, dated, October 5, 2022, to remove ICD-10 dx codes added in error to NCD 150.3, business requirement 12842.4, and restore ICD-10 dx C91.92 removed in error to NCD 110.23, business requirement 12842.3. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11636](#)) (CR12842)

08/2022 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. ([TN 11546](#)) (CR12842)

06/2022 - Transmittal 10832, dated June 2, 2021, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11453, dated, June 10, 2022, to revise NCD 90.2, NGS, revises business requirement 12124.2 and 12124.2.1 and its associated spreadsheet of coding by retaining all ICD-10 NOC diagnosis codes proposed for deletion effective July 1, 2022. ([TN 11453](#)) (CR12124)

01/2022 - Transmittal 11068, dated October 21, 2021, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11179, dated, January 12, 2022 to revise the attachment for NCD 110.24, CAR-T, to add business requirement 12480.10.1 by adding generic unspecified procedure codes, to clarify coverage and claims processing in the policy section and to review the implementation date. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11179](#)) (CR12480)

10/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11068](#)) (CR12480)

09/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11025](#)) (CR12399)

08/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10963](#)) (CR12399)

06/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10832](#)) (CR12124)

05/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10804](#)) (CR12124)

03/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10624](#)) (CR12124)

01/2021 - Transmittal 10515, dated December 10, 2020, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 10566, dated, January 14, 2021 to remove FISS Reason Codes (RCs) 59041, 59042, 59209, and 59210 from the spreadsheet for NCD 160.18. All other information remains the same. ([TN 10566](#)) (CR12027)

12/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, longstanding NCD process. ([TN 10515](#)) (CR12027)

10/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, longstanding NCD process. (TN 10432) (CR12027)

02/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. (TN 2427) (CR11491)

01/2018 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of International Code of Diseases, Tenth Revision (ICD-10) conversions and other coding updates specific to National Coverage Determinations (NCDs). These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. (TN 2005) (CR10318)

11/2017 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of International Code of Diseases, Tenth Revision (ICD-10) conversions and other coding updates specific to National Coverage Determinations (NCDs). These NCD coding changes are the result of

newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 1975](#)) (CR10318)

05/2017 - This change request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1854](#)) (CR10086)

02/2017 - This change request (CR) is the 10th maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates as follows: CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, CR9087, CR9252, CR9540, CR9631, and CR9751, as well as in CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1792](#)) (CR9861)

07/2016 - Transmittal 191 dated April 29, 2016, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 193, dated July 1, 2016 to provide clarifying language for references to the Pub. 100-03 NCD manual, under Summary of Changes. All other information remains the same. ([TN 193](#)) (CR9620)

04/2016 - Effective for claims with dates of service on and after January 27, 2016, contractors shall be aware that the use of allogeneic HSCT for treatment of Multiple Myeloma, Myelofibrosis, and Sickle Cell Disease is only covered by Medicare if provided in the context of a Medicare-approved clinical study meeting specific criteria under the CED paradigm. This CR also clarifies the ICD-9 and ICD-10 diagnosis codes for allogeneic HSCT for treatment of Myelodysplastic Syndromes in the context of a Medicare-approved, prospective clinical study under the CED paradigm. See Pub. 100-03, chapter 1, section 110.23, of the NCD Manual, for further information. Effective Date: 01/27/2016 Implementation Date: 10/03/2016. ([TN 191](#)) (CR9620)

Revision History of 110.23 (formerly NCD110.8.1 prior to 1/27/16, see [CR9620](#))

05/2014 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/06/2014 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1388](#)) (CR 8691)

03/2013 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/07/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1199](#)) (CR 8197)

10/2010 - Effective for claims with dates of service on and after August 4, 2010, contractors shall be aware that the use of allogeneic HSCT for treatment of MDS is only covered by Medicare if provided in the context of a Medicare-approved clinical study meeting specific criteria under the CED paradigm. Effective date 08/04/2010 Implementation date 11/10/2010 ([TN 127](#)) (CR 7137)

09/2009 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 2362](#)) (CR11392)

12/2005 - CMS clarified that bone marrow and peripheral blood stem cell transplantation is a process which includes mobilization, harvesting, and transplant of bone marrow or peripheral blood stem cells and the administration of high dose chemotherapy or radiotherapy prior to the actual transplant. When bone marrow or peripheral blood stem cell transplantation is covered, all necessary steps are included in coverage. When bone marrow or peripheral blood stem cell transplantation is non-covered, none of the steps are covered. Effective date 11/28/2005. Implementation date 01/03/2006. ([TN 45](#)) (CR 4173)

04/2005 - Covered for primary AL amyloidosis when amyloid deposition in 2 or fewer organs and cardiac left ventricular ejection fraction greater than 45%. All forms of non-primary AL amyloidosis remain non-covered. Effective date 3/15/2005. Implementation date 5/16/2005. ([TN 32](#)) (CR 3797)

05/2004 - Removed coding guidance. Coding guidance remains in the Claims Processing Manual. Effective date 7/01/2004. Implementation date 7/06/2004. ([TN 13](#)) (CR 3265)

04/2003 - Removed reference to age as limitation on coverage of stem cell transplantation for patients with multiple myeloma. Effective date 10/01/2000. Implementation date 5/9/2003. ([TN 169](#)) (CR 2604)

11/2000 - Removed age limitation for coverage of autologous stem cell transplantation for patients with multiple myeloma. Effective date 10/1/2000. ([PM AB-00-104](#)) (CR 1375)

08/2000 - Covered for patients with multiple myeloma. Effective and implementation dates 10/01/2000. ([TN 125](#)) (CR 1002)

04/1996 - Clarified that policy for bone marrow transplants applies to all types of stem cell transplants, and added multiple myeloma to conditions excluded from coverage. Effective date 05/24/1996. (TN 84)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation \(AuSCT\) for Multiple Myeloma \(CAG-00011N\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation \(AuSCT\) for Multiple Myeloma \(CAG-00011R\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation for AL Amyloidosis \(CAG-00050N\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation \(AuSCT\) for Amyloidosis \(CAG-00050R\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for Stem Cell Transplantation \(Removal of Coding Information from NCD\) \(CAG-00193N\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Stem Cell Transplantation \(CAG-00287R\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation \(HSCT\) for Myelodysplastic Syndrome \(CAG-00415N\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation \(HSCT\) for Myelodysplastic Syndromes \(MDS\) \(CAG-00415R\)](#)
- [First reconsideration for Stem Cell Transplantation \(Multiple Myeloma, Myelofibrosis, and Sickle Cell Disease\) \(CAG-00444R\)](#)
- [Second reconsideration for Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation \(AuSCT\) for Multiple Myeloma \(MM\) \(CAG-00444R2\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Stem Cell Transplantation (Formerly 110.8.1)	2	03/06/2024 - N/A	You are here
Stem Cell Transplantation (Formerly 110.8.1)	1	01/27/2016 - 03/06/2024	View